EXPERIMENT 7

ROLL NO: 240701161 NAME: HANISHKHA N

Experiment with different layouts and color schemes for an app. Collect user feedback on aesthetics and usability using GIMP(GNU Image Manipulation Program (GIMP)

Procedure to Create Layouts in GIMP

To develop interfaces, follow these steps within the GIMP environment:

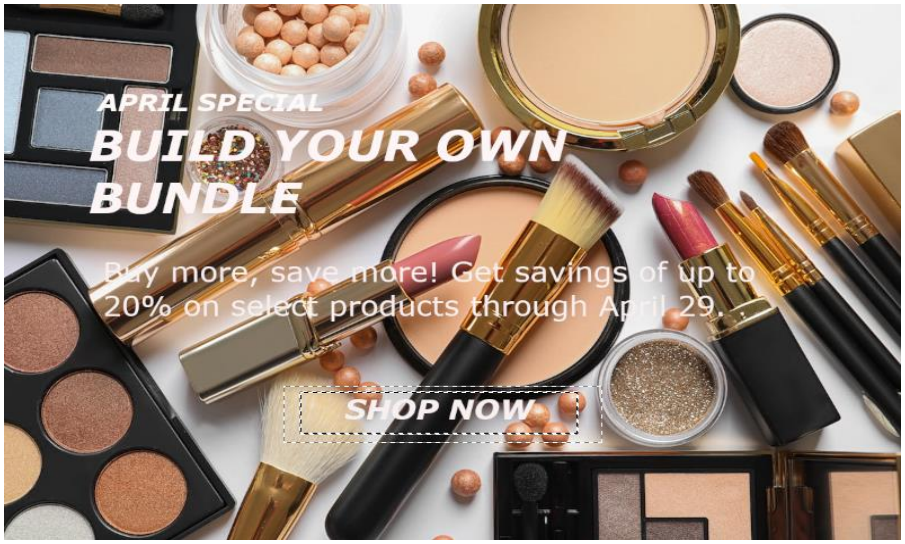
1. **Canvas Setup**: Create a new project (e.g., 1200x800 or 1200x675 pixels) to serve as your workspace.
2. **Import Background Imagery**: Use File > Open as Layers to import high-quality product photography .
3. **Layer Management**: Organize your elements using the **Layers Dialog**. Keep text, buttons, and background images on separate layers to allow for independent editing.
4. **Text Application**: Use the **Text Tool** (Sans-serif font) to add the "APRIL SPECIAL," "BUILD YOUR OWN BUNDLE," and promotional details. Adjust font size and color (white or black) based on the background contrast.
5. **Call to Action (CTA) Button**:
    - Create a new layer for the "SHOP NOW" button.
    - Use the **Rectangle Select Tool** to define the button shape.
    - Use **Edit > Stroke Selection** to create a border or the **Bucket Fill Tool** for a solid background.
6. **Refinement**: Use the **Move Tool** to adjust the layout (center-aligned vs. side-aligned) to ensure the text does not obscure the key products in the image.

Explanation of Themes

The experiment showcases three distinct layouts to test aesthetics and usability:

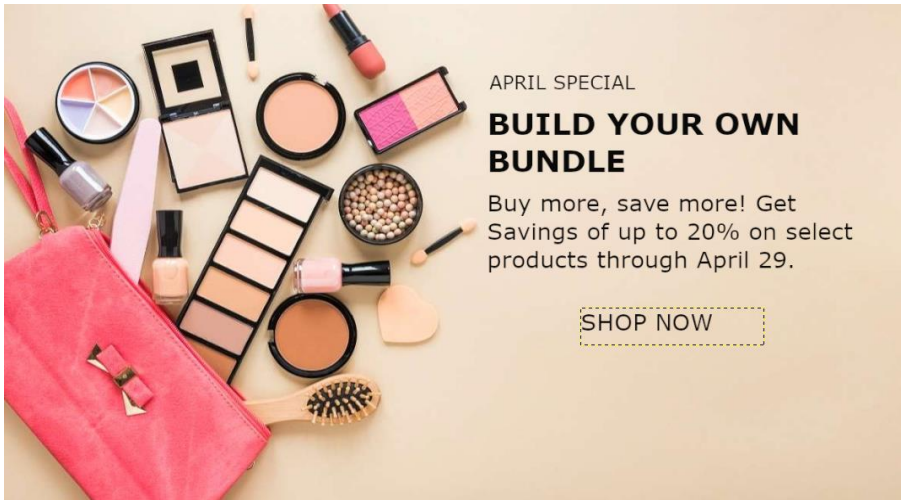
1. The Immersive Overlay Theme (Theme1)

- **Design**: The text is overlaid directly onto a busy, high-contrast background of makeup products.
- **Visual Style**: Dramatic and product-focused. It uses white text to stand out against the darker, varied colors of the cosmetics.



2. The Balanced Split Theme (Theme 2)

- **Design**: The product imagery is grouped on the left, while the text and CTA are placed on a clean, neutral-colored background on the right.
- **Visual Style**: Organized and professional. This layout utilizes negative space to make the promotional text highly readable.



3. The Minimalist Border Theme (Top/Bottom Framing)

- **Design**: The products frame the top and bottom of the canvas, leaving a clear central horizontal band for the text.
- **Visual Style**: Airy and modern. It uses a very light (nearly white) background to create a "boutique" or "luxury" feel.

The layouts were shown to users, and feedback was also collected through g-forms regarding:

- Visual appeal
- Readability
- Ease of use

Most Preferred Theme: Balanced Split (Theme 2)

The **Balanced Split Theme** is generally the most preferred for app usability and aesthetics.

Reasoning:

- **Readability**: By separating the text from the busy product imagery, the promotional message remains clear and easy to scan without visual interference.
- **Hierarchy**: It provides a clear path for the eye—moving from the attractive product visuals on the left to the actionable "SHOP NOW" button on the right.
- **Accessibility**: Using a solid, neutral background for text ensures high contrast, which is a key factor in standard UI/UX design experiments.